Trauma & Warfare – Section Summary

Burns • TBI • Spine • Chest • Coagulopathy • Envenomation • Bioterror

Critical Care Board Review • Section 30 • MCQ-Oriented

1. Burns & Inhalation

- Rule of 9s (front + back trunk + circumferential limb ≈ **45%**)
- Airway burns/stridor → **intubate**
- Smoke: **lactate** surrogate for cyanide

2. Neurotrauma & Spine

- Herniation signs → **hypertonic saline**; early seizure prophylaxis (phenytoin)
- Cleared C-spine on CT (obtunded) → **remove collar**
- IVH with obstruction → **intraventricular tPA** (CLEAR)
- Blunt cerebrovascular injury grade 1 → antithrombotic/BP control

3. Chest & Pelvis

- Rib fractures → **epidural** analgesia
- Retained haemothorax → **VATS**
- Facial/neck trauma, can't intubate → (needle) cricothyroidotomy
- Non-displaced fractures in frail → conservative

4. Viscoelastic Testing

- TEG long R → **FFP**; low α/MA → cryo/platelets
- ROTEM long CT/CFT, low A10 → **TXA, fibrinogen, PCC, FXIII**

5. Envenomation & Bioterror

- Rattlesnake with progression → **antivenom 4–6 vials**
- Necrotic plaque → **Loxosceles** (brown recluse)
- Doxycycline treats plague, tularaemia, RMSF, Q fever

6. High-Yield MCQ Pearls

- ☑ TEG R long → FFP
- ☑ Smoke + lactate → think cyanide

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